

# Riseguide vs. Liven · Coursiv Headway

A side-by-side reputation benchmark across product quality, customer service, user feedback, billing transparency and brand trust · June 29, 2026

RISEGUIDE COMPOSITE

5.5<sub>/10</sub>

▼ -0.1

Mixed

#3 of 4 · Headway leads at 6.3

BIGGEST CHANGE THIS WEEK

Response speed & quality 6.5/10 · ▼ -1.0

COHORT COMPOSITE SCORES

RiseGuide

5.5<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.4 / 5 · Trustpilot  
17,950+ reviews

Liven

5.2<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Apple App Store  
49K iOS ratings

Coursiv

5.8<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Trustpilot  
119,000+ reviews

Headway

6.3<sub>/10</sub>

Watch

4.6 / 5 · Apple App Store  
115K iOS ratings

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · ALL DIMENSIONS

|           |                          | RISEGUIDE                                      | LIVEN                                          | COURSIV                                        | HEADWAY                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 01        | Product Quality          | <div><div></div></div> 7.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.7                     |
| 02        | Customer Service         | <div><div></div></div> 5.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.2                     |
| 03        | User Feedback            | <div><div></div></div> 6.7                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 8.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.6                     |
| 04        | Billing Transparency     | <div><div></div></div> 3.5                     | <div><div></div></div> 2.9                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.9                     |
| 05        | Brand Trust & Legitimacy | <div><div></div></div> 4.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| COMPOSITE |                          | <div>5.5<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.1</div> | <div>5.2<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>5.8<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>6.3<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> |

01

Product Quality

7.3/10

Headway leads this dimension at 7.7/10; RiseGuide sits at 7.3/10 (was 7.3 last week). Headway improved most this week (+0.5 vs. last week).



Marketing vs reality

| RISEGUIDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | LIVEN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | COURSIV                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | HEADWAY <span>LEADER</span>                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Watch · 6.5</div> <p>The promise-versus-reality gap is stable, but the complaint is mutating. Where users once said 'rehashed content,' a handful now claim the lessons and ads are 'AI-generated' — an accusation that surfaced in Google Play reviews and got two Trustpilot reviews flagged for verification this week. Volume is still low and the five-star core is intact, with 70 of 100 App Store reviews landing at five stars, so the score holds. But the new framing attacks credibility rather than quality, and it's worth watching.</p> | <div>Mixed · 5</div> <p>Trustpilot still rewards the CBT wellness positioning, but app-store sentiment is slipping. Bug and slow-performance complaints are increasingly visible — marketed promise diverging from daily-use experience.</p> | <div>Mixed · 5.5</div> <p>Beginner-AI lessons land strongly with first-time users — earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster. Drag remains deceptive-advertising and pricing complaints from outside the funnel.</p> | <div>Healthy · 7</div> <p>Book-summary promise delivered consistently across both stores. Sentiment is net-positive and stable, no new complaint cluster, and YouTube creator coverage is unanimously positive.</p> |

## Unique value proposition

### RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.5

The structured-journey format remains the brand's strongest asset, still earning unprompted praise at a density nothing else matches. This week 69 App Store reviews and 38 Google Play reviews landed in the satisfied-user theme at 4.8 to 4.9 stars, and reviewers again singled out how approachable the lessons feel and how well they fit a specific goal. The unusually high mention count from earlier in June has normalized, but the underlying signal is unchanged: people who finish the journey love it.

### LIVEN

Watch · 6.5

The CBT-companion + mood tracker stack is coherent on paper, but reviewers split on whether the AI companion helps or distracts. The differentiator isn't fully landing.

### COURSIV

Healthy · 7.5

Mobile-first AI skill tracks remain clearly differentiated from desktop video-course competitors. Product experience earned the cohort's most concentrated positive sentiment.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Category leader by every measure: scale, feature maturity, review-base depth. No meaningful movement on the differentiation story.

## Accessibility & consistency

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Healthy · 8

The performance scare from spring stays firmly resolved — when users mention speed and stability now they do so positively, averaging 4.3 stars, and the gap that had been opening with Google Play actually closed this week as its rating edged back up to 4.06. Fewer performance complaints surfaced overall, which is the quiet kind of good news: the topic has receded from the conversation rather than turning negative. Stability is no longer a story here.

### LIVEN

Watch · 6

▲ +0.5

Aggregate ratings are decent, but the iOS bug cluster is the broadest in cohort relative to volume. ADHD/anxiety customisation gaps remain active.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +1.0

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive. We don't have visibility into iOS reviews because that app isn't in our tracking tool — this rating reflects Android only.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +1.5

Aggregate ratings remain strong with a small iOS-Android gap. Structural concern: the support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely. Product consistent; experience around it isn't.

02

## Customer Service

5.8/10

▼ -0.4

**Coursiv** leads this dimension at **6.3/10**; RiseGuide sits at **5.8/10** (was 6.2 last week).

**RiseGuide** regressed most this week (-0.4 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 5.8 ▼ -0.4

Liven 4.0

Coursiv 6.3

Headway 5.2

### Support channel availability

**RISEGUIDE** LEADER

Watch · 6

Coverage is unchanged — email and the help portal carry every conversation, with no live chat or phone line. The model works while volume is manageable, but it has no shock absorber: when complaints spike, the same inbox absorbs them. The next improvement that would actually move this score is a tooling investment, not another hire.

**LIVEN**

Mixed · 4.5

Critical structural gap: the team engages actively on Android but doesn't reply to iOS reviews at all. The 'multi-channel support' claim doesn't hold on the largest store.

**COURSIV** LEADER

Watch · 6

Multi-tier support (email, portal, knowledge base) plus active engagement on visible channels. Less visibility on iOS — that app isn't in our tracking tool.

**HEADWAY**

Mixed · 5.5

Same iOS gap as Liven, newly visible: replies on Android but not iOS. Trustpilot's high reply rate was masking it — once Appbot iOS was added, the dead-zone surfaced.

## Response speed & quality

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

▼ -1.0

**Down from last week. The breakout support story has cooled back to normal. App Store mentions of customer support fell from 18 to 5 this cycle and Google Play from 8 to 1 — the earlier surge was a one-week event, not a new baseline. Tone softened too: a reviewer who cancelled but kept getting charged left unsatisfied after contacting support. Replies are still prompt and mostly positive, but support is no longer the runaway headline it briefly looked like.**

The breakout support story has settled back to normal. App Store mentions of customer support dropped from 18 to 5 this cycle and Google Play from 8 to 1 — confirming the earlier surge was a one-week event rather than a step change. Tone softened as well: one reviewer who cancelled but kept being charged left unsatisfied after reaching out. Replies remain prompt and largely positive, but support is no longer the standout it briefly appeared to be.

### LIVEN

Mixed · 4

Two-track operation: Android reviewers get steady engagement, iOS reviewers get nothing. Multi-week silence pattern reported by users is now confirmed as structural for iOS.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

Where visible, response density is excellent — every Android reviewer gets a reply, including every negative one. iOS visibility gap caps the read at watch-level.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

Same dual-track problem as Liven, exposed for the first time: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Previous high score was Trustpilot-only signal.

## Complaint resolution rate

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

The 'every unhappy customer hears back' promise held perfectly — every negative review across the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot drew a company reply this week. But a reply still isn't a resolution: the share of complaints that actually get closed out trails the response rate, and this week's 'cancelled but still charged, then told no refund' reviews are exactly that gap in action. Responsiveness is solved; resolution isn't.

### LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + Android Appbot strong, but iOS reviews accumulate without any response. Refund and bug threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

100% reply to negative reviews on Trustpilot, but only 63.5% reply rate overall. Selective engagement — they answer negatives when they see them but skip a third of all reviews.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + 100% Android engagement, but iOS shows the same gap as response-speed: every negative iOS review is now ignored. Apple Communities refund-refusal threads remain active.

03

## User Feedback

6.7/10

▲ +0.1

**Coursiv** leads this dimension at **8.1/10**; RiseGuide sits at **6.7/10** (was 6.6 last week). **Liven** improved most this week (+0.7 vs. last week).

RiseGuide

6.7

▲ +0.1

Liven

6.8

▲ +0.7

Coursiv

8.1

▲ +0.7

Headway

7.6

▲ +0.5

## Review volume & rating

### RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.9

▲ +0.3

**Up from last week. Volume growth is broad and the ratings underneath it are steady-to-improving — the healthiest version of this picture in weeks. Trustpilot added roughly 480 reviews this week, a 2.3% increase, holding at 4.4 stars; Google Play added about 80 and ticked up to 4.06; and the App Store kept climbing past 15,900 reviews at 4.6. When volume rises without dragging the rating down, that reads as organic momentum rather than a solicitation push.**

Volume growth is broad and the ratings underneath it are steady-to-improving — the healthiest version of this picture in weeks. Trustpilot added roughly 480 reviews this week, a 2.3% increase, while holding at 4.4 stars; Google Play added about 80 reviews and actually ticked up to 4.06; and the App Store kept climbing past 15,900 reviews at 4.6. When volume rises without dragging the rating down, that's the closest thing to organic-feeling momentum the dashboard shows.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 8.5

Strong cross-platform scale: 27,453 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.13, plus iOS / Android footprints. iOS sentiment meaningfully stronger than Android, but volume itself is meaningful at this scale.

### COURSIV

Healthy · 8.5

Largest review base in cohort by a wide margin — 133,629 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.58, built up in under a year of operating. Heavily invited (99.5% prompted), but volume itself is a credibility asset.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Exceptional · 9

▼ -0.5

Largest absolute footprint in cohort: 6,406 Trustpilot reviews at ★3.93, plus 115K iOS + 169K Android reviews. Trustpilot rating is the weakest in cohort — 6+ years of accumulation surfaces real friction.



Sentiment & platform consistency

RISEGUIDE

Watch · 6

The two app stores are reading almost identically now — both sit around 73% positive in machine sentiment — which is exactly the consistency this criterion tracks, and Google Play even trimmed its negative share. The one soft spot is the App Store, where positive sentiment eased a few points from its spring high, but nothing moved far enough to call a trend. After weeks of the stores diverging, they've settled back into line.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

▲ +2.5

Sentiment consistently mediocre across stores — no managed-channel cushion. Fresh App Store sentiment slipped notably, confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +3.0

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive — but Reddit is the most negative in the cohort. Sharpest managed-versus-organic gap of any brand. iOS data not available.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +2.5

iOS reads moderately positive; Android shows a near-tie between positive and negative. Fresh App Store reviews were notably worse than baseline — the worst fresh signal in the cohort.

## Review authenticity signals

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.5

**Flat from last week. The invited-review problem eased slightly — 97.5% of Trustpilot reviews still came from company invitations, down a touch — but the real authenticity event this week was the return of compliance flags. After two clean weeks, two reviews were flagged, and both allege the positive reviews are 'AI-generated.' Whether or not that's true, it's the accusation that most directly undercuts a 4.4-star average built largely on solicited reviews.**

The invited-review problem eased slightly this week — 97.5% of Trustpilot reviews still came from company invitations, down a touch from near-total — but the headline authenticity event was the return of compliance flags. After two clean weeks, two reviews were flagged, and both allege the positive reviews are 'AI-generated.' The independent tracker RealReviews still places RiseGuide mid-pack at 4.4 stars across 91 ratings. The numbers hold; the accusation that they're manufactured is what caps this score.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

96.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — heavier solicitation than RiseGuide but lighter than Coursiv. The iOS reply silence means iOS reviews accumulate untouched — technically more organic on that store, but also a sign of disengagement.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

99.5% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — the heaviest solicitation pattern in the cohort. Massive volume (134K reviews) counterbalanced by a meaningfully positive organic Reddit signal. Volume is the credibility asset; authenticity is the question mark.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Only 38.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — by far the most organic profile in the cohort. Six-plus years of accumulation produces a naturally diluted invited-share vs the younger heavily-prompted competitors.

## Company responsiveness to reviews

### RISEGUIDE LEADER

Healthy · 8.3

Still the cleanest signal in the scorecard. Every negative review on the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot received a company reply this week, and overall reply coverage held at 100% across all three platforms. Whatever else is contested about RiseGuide's reviews, no unhappy customer is being left unanswered — and that consistency is a genuine, defensible strength.

### LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

Two-track operation: Trustpilot reply at 90.5%, Android Appbot 94%, but iOS reply rate 0%. Previous high score reflected Trustpilot only — once iOS visibility was added, the structural gap became the dominant signal.

### COURSIV

Healthy · 8

Trustpilot reply rate 63.5% — the lowest in cohort despite 120K reviews. Google Play reply rate is 100% including all negatives, suggesting selective engagement. iOS visibility gap is the only thing holding the score back further.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

Previously rated highest in cohort on Trustpilot's reply rate alone (87% on Trustpilot, 90% on negatives). Fuller picture now: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Largest single regression in the benchmark.

04

## Billing Transparency

3.5/10

**Headway** leads this dimension at **3.9/10**; RiseGuide sits at **3.5/10** (was 3.5 last week). All four brands held their dimension scores flat this week.

RiseGuide **3.5**Liven **2.9**Coursiv **3.1**Headway **3.9**

### Price disclosure

**RISEGUIDE**

LEADER

**Mixed · 5**

The two stores keep pulling in opposite directions, so the score sits still. App Store pricing complaints dropped to 8 this week but turned sharply angrier, averaging 1.4 stars down from 3.4, while Google Play pricing complaints rose to 10 but eased slightly to 2.0 stars. Fewer-but-furious on one side, more-but-milder on the other — the net read on how clearly users feel pricing was disclosed simply hasn't moved.

**LIVEN****Critical · 3.5**

Worst pricing-disclosure exposure in the cohort — pricing complaints reached the largest cluster across all four brands. No homepage pricing; users must complete a quiz to see plans.

**COURSIV****Critical · 3.5**

Same quiz-funnel pattern as Liven: no upfront pricing, plans revealed at the end. Trial-to-renewal jump is the dominant friction in third-party complaints.

**HEADWAY****Mixed · 4.5**

Second-worst pricing-complaint exposure despite mature operations. Website FAQ links to a pricing article rather than naming prices — a transparency gap hurting otherwise solid first impressions.

## Hidden / recurring charges

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

#### Critical · 2.5

**Flat from last week. Users still describe being robbed, not misinformed, and this week's words are blunt: 'they will rip you off,' 'auto debit your account without your consent,' 'criminals.' A Trustpilot reviewer warned of a 'hidden auto-renewal at a higher price.' App Store payment complaints stayed harsh at 1.3 stars and Google Play's billing topics all sit around one to two stars. The substance hasn't changed in months — only the vocabulary, which keeps escalating.**

Users still describe being robbed, not misinformed, and this week's language is blunt: 'they will rip you off,' 'auto debit your account without your consent,' 'criminals.' A Trustpilot reviewer warned of a 'hidden auto-renewal at a higher price.' The single highest-leverage fix is unchanged — an explicit 'you will be charged today' confirmation step before purchase — and nothing in this week's reviews suggests it has shipped.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 2

Largest billing-flow exposure in cohort. Auto-renewal complaints are widespread across Trustpilot and unmanaged channels. Trial-to-subscription transition isn't clearly signalled — structural, not noise.

### COURSIV

#### Critical · 2

Billing-adjacent complaints come from multiple vectors at once — payment surprises and deceptive-advertising complaints both active. BBB shows billing as the dominant complaint type historically.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

#### Critical · 2.5

Significant billing-flow exposure despite mature operations. The 'HEADWAY APP IS A SCAM' Apple Communities thread persists, and unexpected weekly-premium charges after a 'free trial' remain the dominant Trustpilot 1-star theme.

## Ease of cancellation

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.5

The documentation rescues whoever reaches it, but reviewers keep hitting a wall the guide can't solve: there's no cancel button in the app. One wrote this week that the cancellation 'functionality does not exist on the app'; another said they were charged for months from an old account they couldn't cancel. This is a discoverability and product-gap problem, not a content one — linking the guide from the in-app billing screen is the cheap half of the fix.

### LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

iOS support sentiment netted out negative, and combined with the iOS reply silence, users trying to cancel can't reach support on the largest store.

### COURSIV

Critical · 3.5

A third-party site publishes a dedicated 'How to Cancel Coursiv' guide — a clear signal that the native flow has enough friction to create a third-party niche.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Watch · 6

Best cancellation infrastructure in cohort: published pre-renewal rule, multiple cancellation paths, no negative support-experience cluster.

## UI dark patterns

### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 2.3

The pattern the company itself acknowledges — charging before a clearly stated renewal date with no email receipt — is still generating angry reviews, and the auto-renewal complaint surfaced again on Trustpilot this week. Compliance flags also returned after two clean weeks, though this cycle's flags were about content authenticity rather than billing. The perception that the checkout is engineered against the user is hardening, not fading.

### LIVEN

Critical · 2.5

Bug complaints and pricing-flow complaints overlap — the combined cluster is the broadest in cohort. Developer publicly acknowledged manipulative rating prompts but underlying upsell flows still flagged as aggressive.

### COURSIV

Critical · 2.5

Deceptive-advertising complaints are a distinctive cohort marker for Coursiv. The quiz-funnel pricing reveal is a textbook dark pattern that consistently surfaces in negative reviews.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Mixed · 4

Lower per-user incidence of dark-pattern complaints than peers. Apple Communities thread about misleading purchase flows persists, but the pattern is softer than what we see at Liven or Coursiv.

## Refund policy clarity & enforcement

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 3

Refunds still run on negotiation, not policy. This week a reviewer who cancelled but kept being charged was told the renewal wouldn't be refunded, while others describe back-and-forth bargaining before any money is returned. With no refund policy published on the website, every outcome depends on which agent you reach. A clear, public refund policy remains the cheapest credibility fix anywhere in this dimension.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 3

Claimed 30-day refund policy is enforced inconsistently — some refunds granted, others refused. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

#### Mixed · 4

Public Money-Back Guarantee exists but requires completing most of the program to qualify — excluding most dissatisfied users. The team engages with negatives but enforces the restriction. Documented policy is a transparency floor.

### HEADWAY

#### Critical · 2.5

No public refund policy. Apple Communities and Trustpilot threads about refund refusals on full-year charges are active. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on iOS are structurally ignored.

05

Brand Trust & Legitimacy

4.3/10

▼ -0.2

Headway leads this dimension at 7.1/10; RiseGuide sits at 4.3/10 (was 4.5 last week). RiseGuide regressed most this week (-0.2 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 4.3 ▼ -0.2

Liven 6.4

Coursiv 4.6

Headway 7.1

Company age & history

| RISEGUIDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | LIVEN                                                                                                             | COURSIV                                                                                                                                                                   | HEADWAY                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Critical · 3</div> <p>Still young and still faceless. The company is roughly two years old and the app about six months, and the only public record of who runs it is a name on business-registration filings. Time will age the brand into credibility eventually, but the one lever available now — a credible founder story — still hasn't been pulled.</p> | <div>Watch · 6</div> <p>Around 4.5 years operating — the second-longest track record in cohort after Headway.</p> | <div>Critical · 3</div> <p>Under a year operating, despite already having a six-figure review base. Youngest entity in cohort; review-base-to-age ratio is anomalous.</p> | <div>LEADER</div> <div>Healthy · 8</div> <p>Six-plus years operating with a recent rebrand and publicly announced IPO plans. Most mature company in cohort by both operating history and corporate sophistication.</p> |



# Legal & brand identity alignment

## RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

▼ -0.3

**Down from last week. The mostly-clean record picked up a blemish this week. After two weeks with no issues, two Trustpilot reviews were flagged for verification — both alleging the app's content and glowing reviews are AI-generated. Dedicated scam-flagging sites still aren't ranking and the skeptical Reddit thread held at the third search result rather than climbing, but the return of compliance flags, paired with the AI-fabrication accusation, is enough to tick this down.**

The mostly-clean record picked up a blemish. After two weeks with no issues, two Trustpilot reviews were flagged for verification this week — both alleging the app's content and reviews are AI-generated. Dedicated scam-flagging sites still aren't ranking, and the skeptical Reddit thread held at the third search result rather than climbing, so this isn't a fraud finding. But the return of compliance flags, attached to an authenticity accusation, is enough to move the score down.

## LIVEN

Watch · 6

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand on billing and legal pages. Cyprus address publicly listed. Credibility signals in organic search results, no complaint domains ranking.

## COURSIV

Mixed · 5

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand, but search results show a concerning share of complaint pages — a billing-vector concern. No credibility-domain anchors surface.

## HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Corporate entity publicly disclosed on the homepage with US registered address. Legal pages comprehensive across terms, privacy, AI usage. Forbes appears as a credibility anchor; brand-owned domains dominate first-page results.

## Third-party recognition

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.7

Independent coverage stays a real asset — several 'is it worth it?' creator reviews rank on the first page and the brand's app overview has been seen over 300,000 times. But two cracks widened this week: the 'is this a scam?' video crossed 15,000 views, and the gap between sold creators and skeptical audiences grew. Across sampled videos 73% were positive, while their comment sections ran only 38% positive — with negative comments roughly doubling their share. The creators are convinced; their viewers increasingly aren't.

### LIVEN

LEADER

Watch · 6

A Board of Health Professionals page lists 15+ named PhDs — a distinctive scientific-credibility signal. YouTube coverage is healthy with almost no complaint-framed videos. Crunchbase appears in search.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6

Listed on Tracxn and Crunchbase, with broad YouTube creator coverage. But organic search results skew complaint-heavy, and there's no editorial press coverage from Forbes, TechCrunch, or peer outlets.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

Strongest third-party recognition stack: Wikipedia, Endeavor entrepreneur backing, recurring trade press around IPO plans, and YouTube creator coverage unanimously positive.

## Leadership transparency

### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

The longest-running flat line in the report. No founder bio, no About page, no leadership presence anywhere in this week's search results — yet again. With reviewers now openly accusing the brand of manufacturing its own testimonials, the absence of a real, named, photographed person to stand behind the product has shifted from a missing nicety to an active liability. A short, photographed founder bio remains the single highest score-per-effort fix anywhere in this scorecard.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Founder publicly named, and an extensive list of health-professional advisors published by name and credential. Leadership identity transparent and verifiable.

### COURSIV

Critical · 3

No founders or executives publicly named anywhere — website, registry filings, or LinkedIn. Anonymous-corporate posture despite a very large customer base — a distinctive cohort outlier.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Founder is public with extensive media presence — interviews, Endeavor profile, recurring press around the IPO. Strongest leadership transparency stack in cohort.

Online presence consistency

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>RISEGUIDE</div> <div>Watch · 6</div> <div>▼ -0.3</div> <div>Where RiseGuide controls the message it's still perfectly aligned — the same contacts and branding appear across the website, both app stores, Trustpilot and business directories. But its search footprint thinned this week: company-owned pages fell from 6 of the top 30 results to 4, with independent review sites taking the vacated slots. The replacements happen to be friendly this time, but ceding owned search real estate is the opposite of the direction this criterion needs to move.</div> | <div>LIVEN</div> <div>Healthy · 7</div> <div>Consistent branding across web, app stores, and Trustpilot. Official Health Professional Board page reinforces brand identity. Corporate address publicly displayed.</div> | <div>COURSIV</div> <div>Watch · 6</div> <div>Branding consistent across visible channels, but corporate and leadership data largely absent — undermines coherence at the trust layer. Organic search shows a concerning complaint-page share.</div> | <div>HEADWAY</div> <div>LEADER</div> <div>Healthy · 8</div> <div>Wikipedia, Crunchbase, official About-us, press coverage, and store listings all reinforce the same brand and corporate identity. Search results contain the broadest unique-domain set in cohort.</div> |
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## 3 IDEAS · NEXT WEEK

# Initiatives that would lift the score

**01 Publish an About-us page with founder bio**

**LIFTS:** LEADERSHIP TRANSPARENCY · 3.0 → ~5 · Single content page — one photo, four links. Ship by Friday.

Liven publicly names CEO Shahrooz Chowdhury + 15 PhD advisors — scores 7. Headway publicly names founder Anton Pavlovsky with press coverage — scores 8.

**How to ship**

- 1 Commission a clean headshot of Oleksandr Matsiuk + draft a 2-paragraph bio (background + why RiseGuide exists)
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/about](https://riseguide.com/about) with photo, bio, and a LinkedIn link
- 3 Link the page from the homepage footer and the App Store / Google Play developer pages

**02 Publish an explicit refund + cancellation policy**

**LIFTS:** REFUND POLICY 3.0 → 4+ · EASE OF CANCELLATION 4.3 → 5+ · Policy page + reply templates — text only, no engineering. Ship by Wednesday.

Headway's published 24-hour pre-renewal rule anchors their 6.0 score on cancellation (best in cohort). Coursiv's public Money-Back Guarantee anchors their 4.0 on refund policy.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a 1-page policy: **7-day no-questions refund + 24-hour pre-renewal cancel rule**
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/refunds](https://riseguide.com/refunds), link from the footer and every billing email
- 3 Update support reply templates + cross-link from in-app billing + store descriptions

**03 Publish a 'How your subscription works' explainer**

**LIFTS:** HIDDEN CHARGES 2.0 → 3+ · PRICE DISCLOSURE 5.0 → 6+ · Support article + email-template update. Text-only, no engineering, no funnel impact. Ship by Wednesday.

Reviewers report surprise at the first payment amount, but the underlying model (introductory discount, then renewal at full price) is industry-standard. The complaint is about clarity of communication, not the pricing itself.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a plain-English article: **introductory price + when full price kicks in + how to cancel**
- 2 Publish at [support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works](https://support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works), link from every billing email + App Store description
- 3 Update support reply templates to cite the article URL on every billing-surprise thread